

Pavan Kumar Nayakanti

Azure Infrastructure & AI-First Consulting Leader | Multi-Cloud | DevSecOps | AKS | AZ-305 | AI-102 | CKAD

+91-9440493097

pavan.nayakanti@hotmail.com

linkedin.com/in/pavan-nayakanti

Hyderabad, India

EXPERIENCE

Sr. Specialist - Cloud Practice & SRE Lead

IRIS Software - India | Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO

Sep 2020 - Present | Hyderabad, India

- Deployed **Azure AI Services**-based assistants for BMO in production - integrating OpenAI/frontier models into Azure cloud infrastructure for risk summarization and Q&A via BCRG and LTS pipelines, reducing manual analysis effort at scale.
- Architected and delivered **multi-cloud infrastructure** (Azure, AWS) for FinTech clients - designing HA/DR frameworks, IaC pipelines (Terraform, AWS CDK), and cloud-native architectures aligned to Cloud Adoption Framework governance principles.
- Scaled ADP's SRE organization from **4 to 40 engineers** across India, Canada, and the US - establishing SLO/SLI frameworks, blameless postmortem culture, and Ansible-driven automated remediation reducing MTTR by **40%+**.
- Built Charles Schwab's **18-member Platform Engineering team** from the ground up - establishing reliability gates, CI/CD standards, and incident governance that achieved 99.9% release reliability within one quarter.
- Delivered the **modeas** high-throughput deployment platform (200+ builds/hr) using Terraform IaC and CI/CD automation - eliminating 10,000+ annual manual ops hours and improving deployment cadence by **600%**.
- Designed the **Cloud Platform Maturity Index (CPMI)** - a reusable governance accelerator deployed across ADP, Schwab, and BMO to drive consistent cloud security, efficiency, and capability maturity.
- Led pre-sales solutioning, technical estimations, and architecture workshops - translating business outcomes into delivery plans and contributing to multiple client engagement expansions.
- Embedded **DevSecOps** practices including shift-left security integration, secrets management, policy enforcement, and compliance validation into delivery pipelines across client engagements.

Automation Technology Specialist - DevSecOps & Platform Engineering

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada | Client: Royal Bank of Canada (RBC Insurance)

Jun 2018 - Sep 2020 | Toronto, Canada

- Embedded **DevSecOps at enterprise scale** across 250+ applications at RBC Insurance - integrating SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, and SAST/DAST/IAST scanning into CI/CD pipelines with SOX/GDPR compliance enforcement and zero audit findings.
- Operationalized the **DORA framework** across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance via **Azure DevOps** - establishing Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics.
- Designed and delivered the **Robo Deployment Framework** - a self-service CI/CD orchestration platform for Windows services, database deployments, and enterprise workloads; reduced application onboarding from 5 weeks to **5 hours (98% cut)**.
- Led enterprise migration of **250+ applications across 60+ teams** from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub Enterprise - enabling modern CI/CD, agile collaboration, and self-service provisioning at scale.
- Implemented Splunk-based observability pipelines integrated with CI/CD - enabling proactive incident detection; contributed to ~\$200K in new project acquisitions through delivery-led pre-sales.

SUMMARY

Azure Solutions Architect and multi-cloud delivery leader with 20+ years designing enterprise infrastructure, DevSecOps programmes, and AI-first solutions for global FinTech clients. Delivered end-to-end consulting engagements for ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO, and RBC -- scaling SRE organisations, architecting cloud governance frameworks, and deploying production Azure AI Services. Returning to Microsoft as Principal Consultant with three Azure certifications (AZ-305, AI-102, CKAD) and a 7-year Microsoft engineering background.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS



SRE Org Scale-Up

Built ADP SRE from 4 to 40 engineers; reduced MTTR 40%+ via Dynatrace + Ansible automated remediation. Built Schwab's PE team from zero in one quarter.



Delivery Accelerator

modeas platform: 200+ builds/hr, 10,000+ manual ops hours eliminated, 600% deployment cadence improvement via IaC and CI/CD automation.



Onboarding 5 Wks to 5 Hrs

Robo Deployment Framework cut RBC application onboarding 98%; 250+ apps across 60+ teams migrated to GitHub Enterprise.



Pre-Sales Impact

Led \$478K SOW at RBC; contributed to \$200K+ in additional client acquisitions through delivery-evidence-backed solutioning.

Automation Architect - Cloud & RPA

IRIS Software - Toronto, Canada | Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets

Feb 2017 - Jun 2018 Toronto, Canada

- Designed fault-tolerant, **container-orchestrated deployment pipelines** using Kubernetes and Helm - enabling zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery automating 80+ applications and 250+ components across Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, and Mainframe stacks.
- Contributed to **\$478K SOW closure** for a DevOps engagement (12-member team, 18 months) and led a \$180K Capital Markets automation pilot through delivery-led solutioning.

Technology Manager - Enterprise Delivery

TechMahindra - Noida, India | Client: Adobe

Jul 2015 - Feb 2017 Noida, India

- Led end-to-end data and code migration from Informatica to SQL Server 2012 for Adobe - schema redesign, ETL re-engineering, and data validation at enterprise scale.
- Architected zero-downtime business application migration during Adobe's data centre relocation - owned full execution and cutover across all production workloads with no service disruption.

Sr. SDET - Production Engineering & Quality

Microsoft Corporation - India

Jul 2007 - Dec 2014 Hyderabad, India

- Held dual mandate as Sr. SDET and Production Engineering owner for Sales & Marketing platforms serving Microsoft subsidiaries across US, EMEA, and APAC - sustaining **99.99% uptime** over 7 years.
- Built QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD pipelines - embedding automated regression, service virtualization, and performance testing into release gates, eliminating manual bottlenecks.
- Managed production operations end-to-end: incident response, RCA, infrastructure administration, and cross-team coordination maintaining zero customer-impacting incidents.

Earlier: Software Consultant / SDET / Intern

Semantic Space Technologies | DRDO | Nuclear Fuel Complex - India

Jan 2002 - Jun 2007 India

- L3 support analyst for Statusmart at CFC/Bank of America (3,000+ sales users); release management, QA, and ETL authoring on SQL Server and Oracle.
- Software consulting for defence-grade, mission-critical applications at DRDO requiring high reliability and security standards.

CERTIFICATIONS

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305)

Microsoft

Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)

Microsoft

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD)

CNCF - 2025

Azure Data Scientist Associate (DP-100)

Microsoft

AWS Solutions Architect - Associate

Amazon Web Services - 2026

Google Cloud Professional Cloud Architect

Google Cloud - 2026

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

PMI

Certified SRE (iSRE) | ITIL® IT Service Operations

iSRE / AXELOS

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence 2024
Woolf University

General Management Program (GMP)
2022
ISB Hyderabad

M.Sc in Computer Science 2002
Osmania University

B.Sc in Electronics 2000
Kakatiya University